

From: Sandra Vermeulen, Regional Operations & Supply Chain
To: Plant Manager
Cc: Quality Lead; Maintenance Lead; HR Business Partner; Finance Controller; Customer Service; Health & Safety Coordinator
Date: Monday, 09:42
Subject: Various items before Thursday + customer audit prep + energy reporting + a few other things we should align on (sorry for the long one)

Hi,

I hope you had a decent weekend, the weather was finally something. I wanted to put a few things together in one message because we keep touching on them in separate calls and I think it is getting hard for everyone to follow what the actual status is and who owns what. Apologies in advance, this turned out longer than I intended, but I would rather have everything in one place than send you five separate mails over the course of the day. Please read fully when you get a moment because there are a couple of things that genuinely cannot wait until next week.

First, the big one. As you know the customer audit for the retail private-label account is confirmed and the auditors will be on site Thursday morning. I had originally understood it was two people but it is now three, including someone from their food safety team who I am told is quite thorough, so we should not assume this is a formality. They want to start at 08:30 in the meeting room and then move to the floor around 10:00. Can you confirm that the meeting room is actually booked because last time there was a double booking and we ended up in the canteen which did not look great. They have asked in advance to see the updated HACCP plan, the allergen segregation procedure, the last three internal audit reports, the corrective actions from the complaint we had in March, the pest control logs for the last twelve months, and the training records for the new operators on Line 4. I think most of that exists but I am genuinely not sure the training records for Line 4 are complete because we onboarded a lot of agency staff over the summer and I have a nagging memory that the signatures were not all collected. Could you have someone check this today or tomorrow at the latest, because if there is a gap I would rather know now and prepare an explanation than be surprised in the room. Also, who is presenting the opening overview? I assumed it would be you but if you want me to take the first fifteen minutes on the regional context I am happy to, just let me know so we do not both prepare the same thing.

Second item, and this is related, is the complaint that came in on Friday afternoon from the same customer about foreign body contamination on a batch from two weeks ago. I do not have all the details yet and the Quality Lead is cc'd here and can correct me, but as I understand it the customer found a small piece of blue plastic in one unit and they have understandably escalated it. The timing is obviously terrible given the audit. We need a holding statement, an initial investigation summary, and ideally a traceability exercise showing which batches are affected and whether anything is still in the market or in their distribution centre. I do not want to overreact before we have facts but I also do not want us to be slow on this. Can the quality team pull the line clearance records and the broken-glass-and-plastic register for that shift and let me know by end of day tomorrow whether we can already say something concrete? If we can show a fast, controlled response it actually plays well during the audit rather than against us.

On a completely different note, but while I have you, the energy reporting. Group sustainability sent a reminder that the monthly energy KPI dashboard is due and our site is the only one in the region that has not submitted yet for last month. I know this is not glamorous and I know the metering on the older part of the plant is not great, but we are getting visibility at ExCo level on energy intensity per tonne produced and I do not want our site to be the red one on the slide for a reason that is just administrative. Can someone confirm the gas and electricity readings for the bakery hall and the freezing tunnels and send me the figures? If the sub-metering is still broken on the proofing area then just give me an estimate with a note and we will flag it as an estimate, that is fine, but I need something. Ideally before Wednesday so I can consolidate the region.

The maintenance backlog is also something I want to raise, not to point fingers, the Maintenance Lead is doing a lot with limited people, but the open work-order list now has a few items that have been open for more than sixty days and a couple of them are on the depositor and the spiral cooler which are not exactly minor equipment. I would like to understand which of these are genuinely waiting on parts, which are waiting on a planned stop, and which are just stuck. If we could get a short prioritised view that would help, and it would also be a good thing to be able to show during the audit that we have a structured planned-maintenance approach rather than running to failure. Is the CMMS export something we can generate easily or is that still a manual job?

Two more things and then I will let you go. The first is the new product trial. R&D; want to run an industrial trial of the reformulated multigrain on Line 2 and they are pushing for the week after next. Before we commit I need to know from you whether the changeover impact is acceptable given we are already tight on capacity, whether the current packaging film works or whether we need the new reel, and whether the team has the bandwidth given everything else going on. I am slightly worried we are saying yes to everything and then surprised when the plan does not hold. What is your honest read on capacity for that week?

The second is holiday planning and staffing. HR is cc'd. We are heading into a period where several of the experienced line leaders have overlapping holiday requests and I am a bit nervous about coverage on nights, especially on Line 4 where we are still building up competence. I do not need this solved today but I would like your view on whether we hold firm on a maximum number of senior people off at the same time, or whether we bring in additional agency support and accept the training overhead. There is a cost dimension here too, which is why Finance is cc'd, because the agency budget is already running ahead of plan for the quarter and the controller will want to understand the trajectory before we add more.

And actually, sorry, one genuinely last thing because it just came up. The budget submission for next year. The first draft of the capex list is due to Finance by the end of next week and I have not seen anything from our site yet. I know the spiral cooler refurbishment and the proposed line-4 automation are likely on there, but I need the list with rough numbers and a one-line justification per item so I can challenge it before it goes up. If you already have a draft, great, send it. If not, can we get thirty minutes in the diary this week to build it together rather than doing it by mail.

I realise this is a lot in one message. If it is easier, we can do a short call, but I genuinely do need clear answers on the audit room booking, the Line 4 training records, the complaint holding statement, and the energy figures, those four are the time-critical ones. The rest can follow this week.

Thanks a lot, I really do appreciate how much you are juggling at the moment, and I think the audit will go fine if we get ahead of these few things now.

Best regards,
Sandra

Sandra Vermeulen
Regional Operations & Supply Chain